DIRECTORY

In addition to the scientists covered in the preceding chapters of this book, many other people have made significant contributions to the development of ecology. They have ranked among the greatest scientific thinkers of their time. Some have excelled in academia, while some came from other walks of life but pioneered new approaches to advance. Still more have been formidable campaigners. Although they worked in a range of disciplines, all have contributed to our understanding of Earth's biosphere, how it has evolved, and humanity's place in it. Crucially, their work continues to show what needs to be done to preserve the natural world and to protect Earth from the destructive consequences of human behavior.

SAMUEL DE CHAMPLAIN

c. 1574–1635

A French explorer, cartographer, soldier, and naturalist, Champlain explored and mapped much of Canada. He founded the city of Quebec and established the colony of New France on First Nations land. As a sharp observer and chronicler, he documented animals and made notes about plants, including details of leaves, fruits, and nuts, and inquired about how the Native American people used them.

See also: Classification of living things

JAMES AUDUBON

1785–1851

The pioneer of North American ornithology, Audubon grew up in Haiti and France before emigrating to the US in 1803. He developed an interest in nature, especially birds, and was a talented artist. His artistic technique was unusual: after shooting a bird, he held it in a "natural pose," using fine wire,